

spacial browser

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Spatial Browser: What Redditors Say and What Exists

What Spatial Browsers Are

- **Concept Summary:** Spatial browsers place web pages as movable/live "cards" on an infinite canvas instead of a tab strip, preserving browsing paths and visual context. "pages live on a canvas instead of a tab strip, so you can actually see the thread. Where you started, what you followed, and how you got here."
- **Common Goal:** Reduce tab chaos and preserve research workflows by arranging, grouping, and connecting pages visually. "every page you open is a card you can drag around on an infinite canvas. Resize them, group them by color, draw lines between related ones, stick notes next to a cluster if you need to."

Existing Projects / Apps Mentioned

- **Marble (marble.surf):** Early-stage spatial browser that saves pages locally, supports dragging pages and drawing connections, shipped on Mac with Windows planned and Linux possible. "Marble is my attempt to fix that: pages live on a canvas instead of a tab strip... Where you started, what you followed, and how you got here. You can browse anywhere, not just one site - drag pages around, draw connections, everything's saved locally."
- **Sowser (Windows, WebView2):** Windows app prototype using WebView2/Chromium; live pages as cards, workspaces saved, AI organize feature (local or Gemini API), minimap, Ctrl+K, tracker blocking, per-card profiles, session restore. "Cards are real WebView2/Chromium instances, not screenshots... You can save/load whole workspaces (.sowser files), plus auto-save and session restore... An AI organize button that groups your open cards by topic — runs locally through Ollama with Gemma, or you can point it at the Gemini API instead."
- **Mission Hub (Vision Pro app):** Spatial browser-like app available on Vision Pro (App Store) that organizes windows in 3D but has early-stage issues (text entry, memory use, app grabbing whole space). "app to partially solve the" "Text entry box never pops up so you need a Bluetooth keyboard to enter URLs... seems like it must consume a lot of memory..."

Reported Strengths & Use Cases

- **Research & Context Preservation:** Many users find spatial layouts helpful for research workflows and visual thinkers. "Seems perfect for research." "I am a designer and I am used to working with art boards. I would love a browser like this."
- **Preserving Path/Tail:** Users value saving the browsing path (collapsible trails suggested). "The strongest part of this is preserving the path, not just arranging tabs spatially... collapse a rabbit hole into a named trail and reopen it later."
- **Cross-Platform Desire:** People ask for Windows, Linux, Android builds and sync. "Mac is shipped, Windows is next. Linux is a possibility..." "What would stop you from making Viola your default browser?"

Reported Problems & Criticisms

- **Scalability / Findability:** At scale, infinite canvases can become as hard to navigate as many tabs; good search is essential. "the failure always arrived the same way... six months later you can't find anything on the canvas either... what saved the ones I kept using was search being good."
- **Performance & Smoothness:** Concerns about resource use and smoothness, especially on older hardware or constrained devices. "Text entry box never pops up... seems like it must consume a lot of memory..." "I mean it's good but why isn't it smooth?"
- **Complexity / Overstimulation:** Some users prefer simpler tab models and find spatial canvases more complicated or visually noisy. "I don't see any benefit to this over chrome? If anything it's more complicated. Personally I also found it too stimulating."
- **Missing Features / Integrations:** Requests for extension support, password manager compatibility, and full platform parity. "is there a way to have extensions like in chrome?" "Can you make it compatible with 1password so I can log in to all the sites I have subscriptions to?"

Features Redditors Want / Recommended

- **Good Search & Organization:** Implement robust search for text inside pages and a way to collapse/save named trails/workspaces. "search being good rather than the layout being clever... find a page from something I only half remember out of its text." "You could have an option to 'save workflows' ... groups of tabs related to one task."
- **Workspace Save/Restore & Export:** Persistent workspace files, session recovery, and cross-device sync to make canvas a long-term memory. "You can save/load whole workspaces (.sowser files), plus auto-save and

pages to static images to reduce the memory cost. You can screenshot a card into a static image and if you don't need it live anymore."

- **Platform & Extension Support:** Desktop + mobile parity and extension compatibility (Chromium-based options cited). "Chromium, embedded with CEF." "Viola is Chromium-based... Chrome Web Store extensions on desktop, installed per profile."

Representative Quotes (direct)

- "Marble is my attempt to fix that: pages live on a canvas instead of a tab strip... drag pages around, draw connections, everything's saved locally."
- "every page you open is a card you can drag around on an infinite canvas. Resize them, group them by color, draw lines between related ones, stick notes next to a cluster if you need to."
- "the failure always arrived the same way... the canvas fixes the tab bar, then six months later you can't find anything on the canvas either... what saved the ones I kept using was search being good."
- "Text entry box never pops up so you need a Bluetooth keyboard to enter URLs... seems like it must consume a

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named trail and reopen it later."

Communities for Further Discussion

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- [r/developersIndia](#)
- [r/VisionPro](#)
- [r/Business_Ideas](#)
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Spatial browsing is actively explored—promising for research and visual workflows—but success depends on search, performance, saving/organizing trails, and cross-platform polish.

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